

Parks Department Meeting December 17th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=i0aw7elrxDQ
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Muncie Park and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Tuesday, December 17, 2024

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Muncie Park and Recreation Board was called to order on Tuesday, December 17, 2024, by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Chandra Par, James Lon, Mark Irvin, Shannon Powers, and Brad Marshall.
 - **Absent:** (None noted)
 - **Presiding Officer:** Brad Marshall (inferred from role managing motions and agenda progression).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the November meeting were reviewed with no revisions or discussion.
 - **Action:** Approved by Voice Vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:01:19 Superintendent Report

- **Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Mineralization/Cleaning:** Completed the majority of mineralization work, including a double-check at Emerson Doll Park to clear air and water from lines, and completed winter cleaning at Tuhey. Spring cleaning will commence in 2025.
 - **Holiday Lighting:** Christmas tree lights were successfully installed and are operational at Canon Common and Killjacks.
 - **Thomas Park (2025 Projects):** A new water line needs to be run from the main to the Thomas Park building in the spring because the previous line lost water function (possibly plugged during splash pad installation). Community Development (Gretchen and Adam City Engineers) are coordinating on utility updates for Thomas and Riverview Parks.
 - **Westside Park Skate Park Signage:** The Mayor's office and city engineer worked with concerned individuals regarding signage. The sign will state "Muncie Skate Park" with a center inclusion indicating "funded by Community Foundation," who is installing the shelter area. Discussions with CRG occurred regarding playground replacements at Westside for 2025.
 - **Muncie Sports Complex Lights:** Lights and scoreboards are scheduled to be removed by Travis as soon as ground conditions dry/harden up. Six lights will be relocated to Westside Park, and the remaining 4 to 8 will go to Muncie Central High School's athletic field. Scoreboards will be stored; one will go to Westside, one to Riverview Park (for neighborhood kickball/daycares), and evaluation is underway for Heekin Park.
 - **Playground Updates:** Renderings for Westside, Heekin, and Alshire parks will be brought before the board in January 2025. Alshire Park estimated re-development costs are around \$100,000 to \$130,000 (including shelter and basketball court).
 - **Tuhey Pool:** The YMCA is anticipated to return to run Tuhey Pool for the upcoming season. An agreement/contract will be placed on the agenda for discussion in January.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.

00:09:02 Programming and Event Approval

- **Presenter:** George Foley.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Youth Employment and Resource Fair:** Scheduled for Saturday, January 4 (10:00 AM <U+2013> 2:00 PM) and Sunday, January 5, 2025 (1:00 PM <U+2013> 5:00

PM) at Minnetrista Museum and Gardens. Saturday will focus on summer internship applications, in-person interviews, and workshops (financial literacy by Northwest Bank, resume building). Sunday will feature on-site interviews for permanent part-time work with partners like Walmart and Falis, along with "Dress for Success" and entrepreneurship workshops, plus resource tables by the NCAA, Girls Incorporated, and Eco Rehab Youth Build. Sponsored by IU Health and Northwest Bank.

- **Baseball Scheduling:** A Zoom meeting is set for Monday with Ken and John to resolve scheduling and Gamebridge logistics. Mr. Anderson confirmed security will be provided for baseball events.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no vote required at this juncture.

00:15:26 Prairie Creek Report

- **Presenter:** Tonnie (Prairie Creek representative).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Piers & Equipment:** Pier removal is moving slowly due to staffing constraints (only 3 crew members) and a recent boat breakdown. Safety challenges moving between wooden piers (waders) and boats were noted, prompting coordination with the sailboat club for future training and equipment (harnesses).
 - **Leases:** Campground leases are completed, alongside 4 to 6 floating pier leases. First-number campground leases are on hold pending decisions on new floating piers.
 - **Lighting Improvements:** Indiana Michigan Power has been replacing outages; 35 light poles need replacement across the park, significantly increasing nighttime visibility.
 - **Events:** The public Christmas event is scheduled for Friday evening (6:00 PM <U+2013> 8:00 PM).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only.

00:20:30 Event Approvals: USA Bassin Fishing Tournaments

- **Presenter:** Tonnie.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Three recurring bass fishing tournament dates requested by USA Bassin, utilizing the boat launch area and tables for weighing fish (25 boats max per event):
 - May 24, 2025 (6:00 AM <U+2013> 4:00 PM)
 - June 21, 2025 (5:00 AM <U+2013> 3:00 PM)
 - August 16, 2025 (5:00 AM <U+2013> 3:00 PM)
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:22:10 Old Business: Prairie Creek Rules & Regulations Updates

- **Presenter:** Board Leadership / Tonnie.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Review of finalized park rules following public feedback sessions. Key updates include:
 - Restricting dock leases to **no more than one dock per individual name**, with dock switches stopping at the end of the year (January 1 implementation).
 - Clarified rules for the beach/windsurfing area, equestrian trails, and multi-use trails.
 - Correction of park opening time typographical error to 5:00 AM to align with city ordinance.
 - Requirement for marine-grade rope for tying boats to piers to prevent dock/cleat damage.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:29:42 Old Business: Tuhey Pond & Park Master Planning Updates

- **Presenter:** Shannon Powers & Board Members.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Tuhey Pond:** State permits are still pending, but project partners (Flatlands, YMCA) are ready to move forward once approved.
 - **Tuhey Park Master Planning:** A recent collaborative meeting at Ball State with Flatlands and the YMCA reviewed maps, parking flow changes, integration of the Ball State-to-downtown public trail, and potential Oralev Grant funding. Community feedback heavily favors playgrounds, botanical gardens, enhanced aquatic amenities, and expanded programming.
 - **Grants Update:** The IU Health Community Impact Grant application for year-round workforce education was rejected in the final round; the board plans to seek specific feedback and reapply, alongside the 21st Century Learning Center Grant. Pending applications include the P Foundation Grant (Heekin Park basketball court/lighting, decision expected late December) and a Musco Lighting grant (\$100,000 for Heekin Park LED lighting, decision expected January 2025).
 - **Ball State Partnership:** Free exercise programming (Chair yoga, Zumba, strength/conditioning) in partnership with Ball State's Healthy Lifestyle Center will launch at MacAuliffe Park in mid-January on Tuesdays and Thursdays.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational updates; no formal vote.

00:38:34 Old Business: 5-Year Master Plan

- **Presenter:** Board Leadership.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Planning for public input sessions in early spring (March meeting anticipated to feature a public session at 6:00 PM prior to the formal board meeting). Community engagement groups (Muncie Action Plan, IU Health healthy lifestyle initiatives) and citizen volunteers (including Larry Strange) are joining the planning committee. The master plan survey remains open online.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion.

00:40:57 New Business: Eagle Scout Project Presentation <U+2013> Store Park Gaga Pit

- **Presenter:** Jacob Collins (Life Scout, Troop 39).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Jacob Collins presented a proposal to construct an above-ground, ADA-compliant (featuring a ramp and steps) hexagon-shaped Gaga ball pit at Store Park as his Eagle Scout project. The project will also serve as a memorial to scout K.K., incorporating a memorial plaque. The parks department agreed to provide gravel for the site base, while project expenses will be funded personally and via Pizza Hut fundraisers. Jacob coordinated with local neighborhood association president Ryan Ellsworth and park staff.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote in full support of the project.

00:51:31 New Business: Prairie Creek Leadership & Working Foreman Role

- **Presenter:** Board Members & Carl Malone.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding the vacant "Working Foreman" / assistant superintendent position at Prairie Creek following a recent resignation. The board discussed the operational need for dedicated leadership at Prairie Creek versus supporting city parks. Ideas included evaluating a shared role structure (splitting time between Prairie Creek and city parks) or budgeting for distinct positions in future fiscal cycles. HR is actively reviewing applications and conducting interviews.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion; further review scheduled for the January 2025 meeting.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:00:34 Carl Malone (Superintendent):** Addressed rising national concerns regarding gun violence and safety in schools and communities. Announced that the department will make community safety, youth support, and violence prevention education a major focus and movement for the parks department in 2025, leveraging resources from juvenile justice networks.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Next regular meeting scheduled for January 2025.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - *Action:* Motion to adjourn approved by voice vote (**01:01:58**).
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